

Basic Units: Syntactic Heads

- The notion of a *head* is used in a wider context than noun phrases
- The verb is considered the head of a clause:
 - Arguments and modifiers are considered its *dependents*
 - **John** ran **home** (“ran” is the head of the clause, “John” and “home” are its dependents)
 - **Bill stupidly** answered **the officer’s question** (“answered” is the head, “Bill”, “stupidly” and “the officer’s question” are its dependents)
- Some schemes view all syntactic relations as head-dependent relations (*dependency schemes*)